MARK

Conversational Version

1:1 THE GOOD NEWS ABOUT JESUS THE MESSIAH, GOD'S SON

The Beginning of John's Ministry

[2]Isaiah the prophet wrote,

"I'll send my messenger ahead of you
to get the road ready *for you* **[Ex 23:20; Mal 3:1],**
[3]***one shouting in the desert,***
'Get the road ready for the LORD!
Make it straight!'" **[Is 40:3]**

[4]John came baptizing in the desert and preaching a baptism of repentance for forgiving sins. [5]The people from Jerusalem and Judaea were going out to have him baptize them in the Jordan *River*, as they confessed their sins. [6]John wore camel's hair with a leather belt around his waist and lived on locusts and wild honey. **Mk 1:1-6**

An Example of John's Preaching

[7]He preached, *"After me someone more important is coming. I'm not even worthy to squat down and unfasten his sandals.* [8]*I'm immersing you with water; he'll 'immerse' you in the Holy Spirit."* **Mk 1:7-8**

The Baptism of Jesus

[9]At that time Jesus of Nazareth in Galilee came, and John baptized him in the Jordan. [10]When he came up out of the water, *John* saw the sky open up and the Spirit come down on him like a dove. [11]A voice came out of the sky, *"You're my dearly loved Son that I delight in."* **Mk 1:9-11**

The Temptation of Jesus

[12]The Spirit took[p] him directly into the desert, [13]and the devil tempted him there for 40 days. He was with the wild animals, and angels were helping him. **Mk 1:12-13**

Introductory Statements
About the Galilean Ministry

[14]After John was arrested, Jesus went to Galilee, delivering God's good news: [15]*"It's time; The kingdom of God is on its way. Repent and believe the good news."* **Mk 1:14-15**

Calling 4 Fishermen

[16]As he was going along Lake Galilee, he saw Simon and his brother Andrew casting nets in the lake; they were fishermen. [17]Jesus said, *"Come with me; I'll have you 'fishing' for people."* [18]They left their nets and went with him. [19]A little farther along, he saw Zebedee's sons, James and John, in a boat, mending nets. [20]He called them, and they left their father in the boat with the hired help and went with him. **Mk 1:16-20**

Teaching and Miracles in Capernaum

21They went[p] to Capernaum and went into the synagogue on the Sabbath, and he started teaching. **22**The people were amazed at how he taught; he was teaching them like someone that had authority, not like the scribes.

23A man in their synagogue had an unclean spirit that shouted, **24***"What is this, Jesus, you Nazarene? Did you come to destroy us? I know who you are: God's Holy One!"*

25Jesus rebuked it, *"Be quiet and come out of him!"* **26**The unclean spirit threw him into convulsions, made a loud noise, and came out.

27They were surprised and started wondering to each other, "*What* is *this? A new* kind of *teaching with authority? He even gives orders to unclean spirits, and they obey."* **28**The news about him spread all over that part of Galilee.

29They left the synagogue and went to Simon and Andrew's house with James and John. **30**Peter's mother-in-law was in bed sick with a fever, and they told him about her. **31**He went and took her hand and raised her up. The fever went away, and she started waiting on them.

32That evening at sunset, people were bringing him the sick and demon-possessed. **33**The whole town gathered at the door. **34**He healed them from many kinds of diseases and cast out lots of demons. He wouldn't let the demons speak because they knew who he was. **Mk 1:21-34**

The First General Tour of Galilee

35In the morning, a good while before daylight, Jesus got up and went out by himself to pray. **36**Simon and the others hunted for him **37**till they found him; *"Everybody's looking for you."*

38He said[p], *"Let's go to the villages nearby so I can preach there too. That's the* main *reason I came out here."* **39**He went around preaching in their synagogues and casting out demons all over Galilee. **Mk 1:35-39**

Cleansing a Leper

40A leper came[p] and pleaded with him on his knees, *"If you're willing, you can cleanse me."* **41**He felt sorry for him and reached out and touched him, *"I'm willing; be cleansed."* **42**Instantly his leprosy disappeared. **43**Jesus spoke earnestly to him and sent him off at once, **44***"Keep this to yourself, show yourself to a priest, and offer for your purification what Moses commanded for a public testimony."* **45**But he went out and started spreading it around, so Jesus had a hard time going into a town openly anymore. He stayed out in rural areas, and people were coming to him from everywhere. **Mk 1:40-45**

Healing a Paralyzed Man

2:1 Several days later, Jesus went back to Capernaum, and people heard he was home. **2**So many people gathered, there wasn't room at the door, and he was speaking the message to them. **3**Four men came[p], carrying a paralyzed man. **4**With the crowd in the way, they couldn't get to Jesus; so they took the roof apart above him and lowered the stretcher with the man on it.

5When Jesus saw their faith, he told[p] the man, *"Son, I'm forgiving your sins."*

6Some scribes sitting there wondered to themselves, **7***"Why's he talking like that? He's blaspheming. Who can forgive sins but God?"*

8Jesus knew what they were thinking,

> *"Why are you wondering about that?* **9***Which is easier: to say to a paralyzed man, 'I'm forgiving your sins'; or to say, 'Get up, pick up your stretcher, and walk'?* **10***Just so you know that the Son of Man has the right on earth to forgive sins"*—he said to the man, **11***"Get up, pick up your stretcher, and go on home."*

12He got up at once, picked *it* up, and went out in front of everybody. They were astounded and praised God, *"We've never seen such a thing."* **13**Jesus went out again beside the lake. The whole crowd went along, and he started teaching *again*. **Mk 2:1-13**

Calling Matthew;
Controversy About Eating with Sinners

14As he was going along, he saw Levi son of Alphaeus sitting at the tax booth. He said[p], *"Come with me."* He got up and went with him.

15He was reclining[p] *at table* in *Levi's* house. Many tax collectors and sinners were reclining *at table* with him and his disciples because many of them were following him. **16**When the scribes of the Pharisees saw him eating with sinners and tax collectors, they started saying to his disciples, *"Why's he eating with tax collectors and sinners?"*

17Jesus overheard it, *"Healthy people don't need a doctor; sick ones do. I didn't come so much to call good people as* to call *sinners."*

Question About Fasting

18The disciples of John and the Pharisees were accustomed to fasting. They came[p] and asked[p] Jesus, *"Why do John's and the Pharisees' disciples fast, but yours don't?"*

19He said, *"Groomsmen can't feel like fasting while the groom's around, can they?* **20***The time's coming when the groom will be taken away from them. They'll fast then."*

21*"Nobody sews a patch of unshrunk cloth on an old garment. The new patch would pull away from the old material and make the tear worse.* **22***Nobody puts new wine in old wineskins. It would burst the wineskins, and the wine and wineskins would be lost. People put new wine in new wineskins."* **Mk 2:14-22**

Controversy About Breaking Sabbath

23On a Sabbath he was going along the grain fields, and his disciples started picking off heads as they went.

24The Pharisees said, *"Why are they doing what's against the Law on Sabbath?"*

25He said, *"You have read, haven't you, what David did when he and his men needed something to eat?* **26***He went into God's house at the time of Abiathar the high priest and ate the consecrated bread that's against the Law for anybody but priests to eat. He gave some to the ones with him.* **27***Sabbath was made for people, not people for Sabbath.* **28***Person takes precedence over Sabbath"*[lit]. **[or lit., "The Son of Man is Lord of the Sabbath."]** **Mk 2:23-28**

Healing a Man with a Paralyzed Hand

3:**1**Again he went into a synagogue. A man with a paralyzed hand was there. **2***Pharisees* were watching to see if he'd heal him on Sabbath so they could accuse him. **3**He told[p] the man, *"Stand up."* **4**He asked[p] them, *"Is it lawful to do good on Sabbath or to do bad, to save life or take life?"*

They didn't say anything.

5He looked around at them angry, dismayed at their lack of compassion. He told[p] the fellow, *"Hold out your hand."* He did, and it was restored. **6**The Pharisees left right away to plot with the Herodians to destroy him. **Mk 3:1-6**

Jesus and the Multitudes

7Jesus went with his disciples to the side of the lake. A huge crowd followed him from Galilee, Judaea, **8**Jerusalem, Idumea, from beyond the Jordan, and from around Tyre and Sidon. They came because they heard about the things he was doing.

9He told his disciples to bring a boat up close so the crowd wouldn't throng him. **10**He'd healed so many people that everybody with an ailment was crowding up to touch him. **11**When unclean spirits would see him, they'd kneel down to him and cry out, *"You're God's Son."* **12**He'd strictly order them not to tell who he was. **Mk 3:7-12**

Calling the Twelve Apostles

13He went up[p] on a mountain and called the ones he wanted. **14**He appointed twelve and named them apostles. *He appointed them* to be with him so he could "send" them out to preach **15**and have authority to cast out demons. **16***The Twelve were* Simon, that he named Peter; **17**James and John, sons of Zebedee, that he nicknamed Boanerges (Sons of Thunder); **18**Andrew, Philip, Bartholomew, Matthew, Thomas; James son of Alphaeus, Thaddaeus, Simon the Zealot, **19**and Judas Iscariot, who *later* betrayed him. **Mk 3:13-19**

The Pharisees' Charge That
Jesus Was in League with the Devil

20He came[p] home, and again such a crowd gathered[p] that *he and his disciples* couldn't even eat. **21**When his neighbors heard about it, they went out to rescue him because they said he was out of his mind. **22**Scribes, down from Jerusalem, started claiming he had Beelzebub—that he was casting out demons by the ruler of demons. **23**He called them over and gave them an illustration:

> *"What sense does it make to say Satan casts out Satan?* **24***A kingdom at cross purposes with itself can't stand.* **25***A family at cross purposes with itself can't stand.* **26***If Satan opposes himself and is at cross purposes, he can't stand.* **27***Nobody can go into a strong man's house and seize his property unless he ties him up first. Then he can ransack* his *house.*
>
> **28***I tell you, any sin can be forgiven, including blasphemy;* **29***but anybody that blasphemes the Holy Spirit will never be forgiven; they're guilty of permanent sin"* (**30**He gave that warning because they were saying he had an unclean spirit.) **Mk 3:20-30**

Jesus' Mother and Brothers

Interrupt His Ministry

31His mother and brothers came[p] and stood outside and sent a message, calling him. **32**The crowd sitting around him said[p], *"Your mother and brothers [and sisters] are outside, they want to talk to you."*

33He answered[p], *"Who are my mother and my brothers?"* **34**He looked all around at the ones, *"My mother and my brothers!* **35***Whoever does God's will, is my brother, my sister, my mother."* **Mk 3:31-35**

The Sermon in Stories

4:1 Later he was trying to teach by the lake, but the crowd was[p] so big he got in a boat on the water and sat down. The crowd was on the shore.

2He started teaching them with stories.

3"*Listen. A sower went out to sow.* **4***As he sowed, some seed fell along the path, and birds came and gobbled it up.* **5***Some fell on rocky ground, where there wasn't much soil. It sprouted up right away because the soil was thin.* **6***But when the sun climbed high, it scorched and shriveled up because it didn't have roots.* **7***Some seed fell among thorns, and the thorns grew up and choked it out, and it didn't produce anything.* **8***But other seed fell on good ground, came up, grew, and produced 30, 60, 100 times over.* **9***Whoever has ears, listen!"*

10When he was by himself, the ones around him with the Twelve asked him about the stories. **11**He told them, *"You're allowed to know the unrevealed things about The kingdom of God, but to people outside I'm doing things in stories* **12***so*

'They'll certainly see, but not perceive;
they'll certainly hear, but not understand,
be converted, and
I forgive them' **[Is 6:9-10].** **Mk 4:1-12**

13*"You don't understand this story? How will you understand any story?* **14***A sower sows the message. Some* seeds *fall beside the path where the message is sown.* **15***When they hear it, Satan comes at once and takes away what was sown in them.* **16***Some fall on rocky soil. When they hear the message, they're glad and accept it right away.* **17***But they don't have root in themselves and just last a while. When trouble or persecution comes on account of the message, they stumble.* **18***Some* seeds *fall among thorns. They hear the message;* **19***but the cares of this age, the deception of wealth, the desire for other things come in and choke them out, and they don't produce anything.* **20***Others fall on good ground; they hear the message, accept it, and produce 30, 60, 100 times as much as was sown."*

21*"People don't take a lamp and put it under a basket or a bed, do they? Don't they put it on a stand?* **22***Nothing is hidden that won't be revealed; nothing is secret that won't come to light.* **23***Whoever has ears, listen!"*

24 *"Be careful what you listen to. The measure you measure with, you'll be measured by—and more so.* **25***Those who have, will receive more; those who don't have, will lose what they do have."* **Mk 4:13-25**

26 *"The kingdom of God is like a man that puts seed in the ground.* **27***He sleeps and gets up day after day, but he doesn't know how the seed sprouts and grows.* **28***The ground produces crops on its own—the stalk, the head, then the seed in the head.* **29***When the crop is ready to harvest, he gets out his scythe to harvest it."*

30 *"What can we compare The kingdom of God to? What's it like?* **31***It's like a mustard seed, which is smaller than any other seed people plant.* **32***Yet it grows up bigger than the other garden plants and puts out branches, so birds build nests in its shade.*

33Only with stories like those was he delivering the message to them as they could understand. **34**Privately he'd explain them to his disciples. **Mk 4:26-34**

Stilling the Storm

35That evening he said[p], *"Let's go to the other side."* **36**They left the crowd and took him along in the boat like he was; *some* other boats went along. **37**A dangerous storm came up[p] and was sloshing waves into the boat and filling it up. **38**He was in the back of the boat, sleeping with his head on a cushion. They woke[p] him up, *"Rabbi, don't you care that we're aboout to die?"* **39**He got up and rebuked the wind and waves, and a general calm settled in. **40** *"Why are you so scared? Don't you trust me yet?"* **41**They were even more scared now, *"Who is this that even the wind and waves obey?"* **Mk 4:35-41**

Healing the Gadarene Demoniacs

5:1 They came to the other side of the lake, to the area of the Gerasenes. **2**As soon as he got out of the boat, a man with an unclean spirit met him from the tombs. **3**He'd been living in the tombs, and nobody could tie him up anymore. **4**People had often bound him with shackles and chains. He'd pulled the chains apart and break the shackles in pieces. Nobody was strong enough to subdue him. **5**Constantly day and night in the tombs and in the hills, he'd scream and cut himself with stones. **6**When he saw Jesus a long way off, he ran and bowed to him **7**and screamed[p], *"What is this, Jesus, Son of God Most High! I beg you by God not to torment me!"* (**8**He said that because Jesus had told the unclean spirit to come out of him.)

9He asked him, *"What's your name?"*

"'Legion'; there are lots of us." **10**He begged Jesus not to send them out of the area. **11**A tremendous herd of pigs was feeding on the hillside. **12** *"Send us into the pigs."* **13***Jesus* let them. They went into the herd of about 2,000, which stampeded down the steep hill into the lake and drowned.

14The herdsmen ran away and reported it in town and in the countryside, and people came to see what had happened. **15**They came[p] over to Jesus and saw the demon-possessed man sitting there dressed and in his right mind, and they were afraid. **16**The people that had seen it

described to them how it happened with the demoniac and the pigs. **17**The people started begging Jesus to leave their territory.

18As he was getting in the boat, the demoniac begged to go along; **19**but Jesus told[p] him, *"Go home to your family and tell them how much the Lord has done for you and how he was merciful to you."* **20**He went and told in the Decapolis what all Jesus had done for him, and everybody was amazed. **Mk 5:1-20**

Raising Jairus' Daughter;
Healing a Woman with Chronic Hemorrhaging

21When Jesus crossed back over to the other side in the boat, a big crowd had gathered beside the lake. **22**A ruler of the synagogue, named Jairus, saw him, came[p] and fell down[p] to him, **2**and pleaded[p], *"My little girl is at the point of death. Please come and lay hands on her so she'll live."* **24**Jesus went with him.

A big crowd was following him and pressing in on him. **25**A woman there had been hemorrhaging for twelve years. **26**She'd been put through a lot by doctors and spent everything she had without any benefit—but got worse. **27**When she heard about Jesus, she came up behind him in the crowd and touched his clothes. She'd said, **28***"If I can just touch his clothes, I'll be cured."* **29**Instantly her bleeding stopped. She could feel she was healed from the scourge she'd been dealing with for so long.

30At once Jesus sensed that power had gone out of him. He turned around in the crowd, *"Who touched my clothes?"*

31His disciples said, *"You see the crowd pressing in on you and you say, 'Who touched me?'"*

32He kept looking around to see who did it. **33**The woman, afraid and nervous, knew what had happened to her. She came and fell down to him and admitted the whole thing.

34*"Daughter, your faith has cured you. Have a good day and stay healed from your ailment."*

35While he was speaking, they came[p] from the synagogue ruler's *house*, *"Your daughter has died; why concern the Rabbi further?"*

36Jesus overheard it and told[p] him, *"Don't give up; just trust me."*

37He only let Peter, James, and his brother John follow him. **38**When he came[p] to the man's house and saw the confusion and the people crying and loudly wailing, **39**he went in and said[p], *"Why are you making such a scene? The girl's not dead; she's 'asleep.'"* **40**They started ridiculing him. He put them all out and took her parents and the three with him into where the girl was. **41**He took her hand and said, "*Talitha, qum (Girl, get up)."* **42**She stood up right away and started walking around. (She was twelve.) They were completely astounded. **43**He gave them strict orders that nobody should know about this and told them to give her something to eat.
Mk 5:21-43

Last Visit to Nazareth

6:1 He left for his hometown with his disciples. **2**When Sabbath came, he taught in the synagogue, and many were astonished when they heard[p] *him*: *"Where'd he get that wisdom and those miracles he does with his hands? **3**Isn't this the builder, Mary's son and the brother of James, Joseph, Judas, and Simon? Aren't his sisters here?"* They were put off by him.

4Jesus told them, *"A prophet is respected everywhere except in his hometown, among his relatives, in his own family."* **5**He couldn't do any miracle there—except he did lay hands on a few sick people and healed them. **6**He was amazed at their disbelief.

He continued to move around the villages and teach. **Mk 6:1-6**

Mission of the Twelve

7He called[p] the Twelve aside and got them ready to go out in pairs with authority over unclean spirits. **8**He instructed them not to take anything except a staff—no bread, traveler's bag, or money in their belt, **9**but to wear sandals. *"Don't take two shirts to wear.* **10***Stay at whatever house you go into till you leave the area.* **11***If a place doesn't welcome you or listen to you, leave and shake the dust off your feet as a statement to them."* **12**They went out and preached that people should repent. **13**They were casting out demons and anointing many sick people with olive oil and healing them. **Mk 6:7-13**

Herod's Stricken Conscience

14King Herod[Antipas] heard about *him* because Jesus had become well known. People were saying John the Baptist had arisen from the dead and that was why miraculous powers were working in him. **15**Others were saying he was Elijah or like one of the prophets. **16**When Herod heard about it, he said, *"John that I beheaded has resurrected."* **17**Herod himself had sent and arrested John and bound him in prison on account of Herodias, his brother Philip's wife, because he'd married her. **18**John kept telling Herod, *"It's against the Law for you to be living with your brother's wife."* **19**Herodias had a grudge against him and wanted to have him killed; but she couldn't **20**because Herod was afraid of him. He knew he was upright and holy, and he protected him. He listened to him many times and was confused, but he liked to listen to him.

21A chance came on his birthday when Herod held a banquet for his officials, military commanders, and prominent men of Galilee. **22**When, *Salome*, his step-daughter—*daughter* of Herodias—came in and danced, it pleased Herod and the ones reclining *at table* with him. The king said to the girl *"Ask for whatever you want, and I'll give it to you."* **23**He strongly swore to her, *"I'll give you whatever you ask for up to half my kingdom."*

24She went out and asked her mother what to ask for.

"The head of John the Baptist!"

25She hurried back and asked, *"I want you to give me right now on a platter the head of John the Baptist."*

26Herod became deeply grieved; but because of his oaths and the guests, he wasn't willing to refuse her. **27**He sent an executioner to bring John's head. He went and beheaded him in the prison, **28**brought his head on a platter and gave it to the girl, and she gave it to her mother. **29**When his disciples heard about it, they came and got his corpse and put it in a tomb. **Mk 6:14-29**

Feeding the 5,000

30The apostles *he'd sent out* came back[p] to Jesus and reported what all they'd done and taught. **31**He said[p], *"Come off by yourselves away from the crowds and rest awhile."* So many people were coming and going they didn't even have time to eat. **32**They left in a boat to a place off by themselves.

33People saw them leaving and many figured out where they were going. They ran from the towns and got there ahead of them. **34**When he got out *of the boat*, he saw a large crowd and felt sorry for them: they were like sheep without a shepherd. He began to teach them a lot of things.

35When it was getting quite late, his disciples came to him, *"Nobody lives around here, and it's getting late.* **36***Dismiss them so they can go into the countryside and villages to buy food."*

37But he answered, *"You feed them."*

"Should we go spend 200 denarii on bread to feed them!?"

38*"Go see how many loaves you have."*

They found five, and two fish.

39He told *his disciples* to have everybody sit down on the green grass **40**in groups of 50 and 100. **41**He took the five loaves and two fish, and looked up at the sky, blessed and broke the loaves, and started giving *them* to his disciples to pass out to the crowd, and distributed the two fish for everybody. **42**They all ate till they were full. **43***The disciples* picked up twelve baskets of fish and bread pieces. **44**5,000 men had eaten the loaves. **Mk 6:30-44**

Jesus Walking on the Water

45Jesus urged his disciples to get in the boat right away and go on to Bethsaida, on the other side, while he dismissed the crowd. **46**When he'd said goodbye to them, he went up on the hill to pray. **47**In the evening the boat was out on the lake, and he was by himself on land. **48**He saw them straining at the oars because the wind was against them. About 4 in the morning, he went to them walking on the water as if he intended to go on by. **49**When they saw him walking on the water, they thought he was a ghost and cried out **50**terrified. At once he spoke[p], *"It's me. Don't let me scare you."* **51**He climbed up into the boat with them and the wind died down. They were astounded. **52**They hadn't got the point about the loaves. They weren't catching on.

Mk 6:45-52

Miracles at Gennesaret

53When they'd crossed over to land, they tied up at Gennesaret. **54**As soon as they got out of the boat, people recognized him. **55**They hurried around the vicinity and started bringing sick people on stretchers to wherever they would hear he was. **56**Whatever villages, towns, or countryside he'd go to, they'd put sick people in the marketplaces and appeal to him just to touch his clothes. As many as touched him were cured. **Mk 6:53-56**

Attack by the Jerusalem Pharisees About Traditions

7:1 Pharisees and some scribes from Jerusalem **2**had seen some of his disciples eat[p] with defiled—unwashed—hands. (**3**The Pharisees and all the Jews always wash their hands vigorously before they eat—keeping the tradition of the elders. **4**When they come in from the marketplace, they don't eat unless they take a bath. They keep many other customs—ritual washing of cups, pitchers, bronze kettles [and bedrolls][ms].) **5**They gathered around Jesus and asked, *"Why don't your disciples follow the tradition of the elders instead of eating with defiled hands?"*

6He told them,

"Isaiah described you hypocrites well when he wrote:

'This people honors me with their lips,
but their heart is far from me.
7*They worship me without meaning anything, and*
teach human rules as* God's *doctrines' **[Is 29:13 LXX].**

8-9*You neatly set aside divine commandment to establish human tradition.* **10***A case in point: Moses said,* ***'Honor your father and your mother'*** **[Ex 20:12; Deut 5:16]***, and,* ***'Put to death whoever cusses at** his **father or mother'*** **[Ex 21:17].** **11***But* <u>you</u> *say, 'If a person tells his father or mother, "Whatever would have helped you is 'Corban ('Given').'" **12***You let him do nothing for his parents.* **13***You negate God's word with* your *tradition. You do a lot of things like that."*

14He called the crowd again, *"Listen, all of you, and get this.* **15***Nothing that goes in you can defile you. It's what comes out of you that defiles you."* [**16**]ms

17When he went into the house away from the crowd, his disciples asked him about the illustration.

18*"Don't* <u>you</u> *get it either? Don't you know that nothing that goes into you can defile you.* **19***It doesn't go into your heart, but into your stomach, and is eliminated in the toilet* (a comment that *cleanses all food ceremonially*)? **20***What comes out of you is what defiles you.* **21***From the inside—from your heart—come sinful thoughts, sexual immorality, theft, murder,* **22***adultery, coveting, evil intentions, deception, indecency, jealousy, pride, senselessness.* **23***Sinful things from inside you are what defile you."* **Mk 7:1-23**

Healing the Syrophoenician Woman's Daughter

24From there he traveled to the locale around Tyre and went into a house because he didn't want anybody to know *it*, but he couldn't hide. **25**Right away, a woman whose daughter had an unclean spirit heard about him and came and fell down to him. **26**She was a Greek, a Syrophoenician. She kept asking him to cast out the demon.

27He told her, *"Let the kids eat first. It's not right to take their food and toss it to the dogs in the house."*

28But she answered, *"Lord, even house dogs under the table eat the kids' scraps."*

29*"Because of that comment,* you can *go; the demon has come out of your daughter."*

30When she went in her house, she found the little girl lying on her bed and the demon gone. **Mk 7:24-30**

Ministry in Decapolis;
Feeding the 4,000

31He left the area around Tyre and traveled through Sidon to Lake Galilee in the territory of Decapolis. **32**They brought[p] him a deaf man with a speech impediment and asked[p] him to put his hand on him. **33**He took him away from the crowd and put his fingers in his ears, spit, and touched his tongue. **34**He looked up at the sky, and made a groaning sound and said[p], "*Ephphatha (Open up)*." **35**His ears opened and his tongue freed up, and he started speaking clearly. **36**Jesus told the people not to tell anybody, but the more he told them to keep something quiet, the more

they spread it around. [37]They were completely astonished, *"He's done everything well. He even makes deaf people hear and mutes speak."* **Mk 7:31-37**

8:[1]At that time again, the large crowd didn't have anything to eat. Jesus called[p] the disciples over, [2]*"I feel for the crowd. They've stayed with me three days already and don't have any food.* [3]*If I send them home hungry, they'll collapse on the way. Some of them have come a long way."*

[4]His disciples answered, *"Where can anyone satisfy them with breadout here in the rural area?"*

[5]*"How many loaves do you have?"*

"Seven."

[6]He told[p] the crowd to sit down. He took the seven loaves, blessed them, and gave them to his disciples to distribute to the crowd. [7]They had a few small fish. He blessed them and said to pass them out too. [8]The people ate till they were full, and the *disciples* picked up seven large baskets of leftover pieces. [9]About 4,000 people were there, and he dismissed them. [10]Directly he got in the boat with his disciples and went to the vicinity of Dalmanutha. **Mk 8:1-10**

Visit to Magadan;
Demand for a Sign from the Sky

[11]The Pharisees came and started arguing with him and demanding a sign from the sky—testing him. [12]He groaned under his breath, *"Why do people today keep looking for a sign? They're not going to get one."* [13]He got in the boat again and went back to the other side.

Mk 8:11-13

Fourth Withdrawal East of the Lake;
Warning to the Disciples

[14]The disciples had forgotten to take bread along and only had one loaf left in the boat. [15]He gave them strict orders, *"Watch out for the 'yeast' from the Pharisees and Herod."* [16]They started reasoning with one another *that his comment was* because they did not have any bread. [17]He knew it and said[p],

"Why in the world are you talking about not having any bread? Don't you get it yet? Are you dense? [18]*Do you have eyes that can't see, and ears that can't hear? Don't you remember* [19]*how many medium-sized baskets of leftover pieces you picked up when I broke the five loaves for the 5,000?"*

"Twelve."

[20]*"How many large baskets of leftovers did you pick up when I broke the seven loaves for the 4,000?"*

"Seven."

[21]*"You still don't get it?"*

[22]They went[p] to Bethsaida, and people brought[p] Jesus a blind man and asked[p] him to touch him. [23]He led him by the hand out of the village. He spit in his eyes and put his hands on him, *"Do you see anything?"*

[24]He looked up and said, *"I can see people—like trees—walking."*

25Jesus put his hands over the man's eyes again; the man looked intently, and his sight
came back clear.
26Jesus sent him home, *"Don't go back into the village."* **Mk 8:14-26**

Peter's Great Confession

27Jesus and his disciples went out to the villages around Caesarea Philippi. On the way he
asked them, *"Who are people saying I am?"*
28*"John the Baptist; others, Elijah; others, that you're one of the prophets."*
29*"Who do <u>you</u> say I am?"*
Peter answered, *"You're the Messiah."*
30Jesus told them not to tell anybody. **Mk 8:27-30**

The First Prediction of Messiah's Death

31He started explaining to them that the Son of Man had a lot to suffer; be rejected by the
elders, chief priests, and scribes; be put to death, and resurrect after three days. **32**He was talking
about the matter openly, and Peter pulled him aside and began to scold him. **33**He turned around
and saw his disciples and scolded Peter, *"Get behind me, Satan. Your mind's not on God's
interests, but human interests."*
34He called the crowd with his disciples,

> *"If people want to follow me, they have to set aside their own interests,
> pick up their cross, and follow me.* **35***Whoever wants to save their life will lose it;
> whoever loses their life on account of me and the good news will save it.* **36***What
> good does it do anyone to gain the whole world and forfeit their life?* **37***What
> would they give in exchange for their life?* **38***Whoever's ashamed of me and my
> message in this adulterous, sinful time, the Son of Man will be ashamed of when
> he comes in his Father's glory with his holy angels.* **9:1***Some* of you *standing here
> will certainly live to see The kingdom of God come with power."* **Mk 8:31-9:1**

The Transfiguration

2Six days later Jesus took[p] Peter, James, and John up on a mountain by themselves, and
was transfigured in front of them. **3**His clothes turned brilliant white like no laundryman can
bleach them. **4**Elijah appeared with Moses, talking to Jesus. **5**Peter responded[p], *"Rabbi, it's good
to be here. Let's set set up three tents—one each for you, Moses, and Elijah."* **6**He didn't know
what to say because they were afraid. **7**A cloud engulfed them, and a voice came out of it, *"This
is my dearly loved Son; listen to him."* **8**Suddenly they looked around and didn't see anybody but
Jesus. **Mk 9:2-8**

Discussing the Vision

9As they were coming back down the mountain, he impressed on them not to pass on to
anybody what they'd seen till the Son of Man arose from the dead. **10**They kept the matter to
themselves and wondered what *"arising from the dead"* meant.
11They asked him, *"Why do the scribes say Elijah has to come first?"*

12 *"Elijah does come first to restore everything, and how does the scripture say that the Son of Man has to suffer many things and be rejected?* **13***But Elijah has in fact come, and they treated him however they wanted to, like scripture says."* **Mk 9:9-13**

Healing the Demoniac Boy

14When they got back to the rest of the disciples, they saw a big crowd around them and scribes arguing with them. **15**When they saw him, the whole crowd was really surprised and ran to greet him. **16**Jesus asked, *"Why are you arguing with them?"*

17A man in the crowd answered him, *"Rabbi, I brought you my boy. He has a spirit that makes him unable to talk.* **18***Wherever it seizes him, it throws him on the ground. He foams at the mouth and grinds his teeth and becomes rigid. I spoke to your disciples about casting it out, but they couldn't do it."*

19 *"Unbelieving bunch, how long am I going to be with you? How long am I going to deal with you? Bring him to me."*

20When the spirit saw Jesus, it threw the boy into convulsions. He fell on the ground and started rolling around and foaming at the mouth.

21*Jesus* asked his dad, *"How long has this been going on?"*

"Ever since he was little. **22***Lots of times it even throws him into the fire or the water to destroy him. But if you can, help us; have sympathy for us."*

23Jesus said, *"'If you can'? Everything's possible for someone that believes."*

24His dad cried out, *"I believe! Help my unbelief!"*

25When Jesus saw a crowd quickly coming together, he commanded the unclean spirit, *"Mute and deaf spirit, I charge you to come out of him and don't go into him again."*

26It cried out and threw him into severe convulsions and came out. The boy looked like he was dead, so much so that many of them said he'd died. **27**But Jesus took hold of his hand to raise him up, and he stood.

28When Jesus went into a house, his disciples asked him privately*, "Why couldn't <u>we</u> cast it out?"*

29 *"This kind doesn't come out except by prayer."* **Mk 9:14-29**

Third Prediction of His Death

30They left and began traveling around Galilee. He didn't want anybody to know it, **31**because he was trying to teach his disciples, *"I'm going to be betrayed to authorities that will put me to death. Three days later I'll resurrect."* **32**They didn't understand, but they were reluctant to ask him about it. **Mk 9:30-32**

Discussion About Rank

33When they came home to Capernaum, he asked them, *"What were you*^{pl} *arguing about on the road?"* **34**They kept still because they'd been arguing about who had highest rank. **35**He sat down and called the Twelve over, *"If anybody wants to be first, he'll put himself last as servant of all."* **36**He took a little child and stood him among them and put his arms around him, **37** *"Whoever receives one of these children in my name receives me, and whoever receives me receives the One that sent me."*

The Unknown Exorcist

38John said, *"Rabbi, we saw a fellow casting out demons in your name and tried to stop him because he wasn't following us."*

39"*Don't stop*[pl] *him. Nobody that performs a miracle in my name will turn right around and say something bad about me.* **40***Whoever is not against us is for us.* **41***Whoever gives you a cup of water in my name because you're following the Messiah, will certainly not miss out on his reward.* **Mk 9:33-41**

The Question of Stumbling Blocks

42*"Whoever makes one of these little ones stumble that believes in me, would be better off to have a large millstone put around their neck and be thrown into the sea.* **43***If your hand causes you problems, amputate it. It's better to go about life deformed than to have two hands and go to hell—into the unquenchable fire. [*[44]*]*[ms] **45***If your foot causes you problems, amputate it. It's better to go about life deformed than to have two feet and be thrown into hell. [*[46]*]*[ms] **47***If your eye causes you problems, gouge it out. It's better to get in The kingdom of God with one eye than to have two eyes and be thrown into hell,* **48***where the worms don't die, and the fire doesn't burn out.*

49*"Everybody will be tested with fire.* **50***Salt's good, but if it loses its saltiness, how will you make <u>it</u> salty? Have salt in yourselves and get along with each other."* **Mk 9:42-50**

Jesus in Perea;
Teaching About Divorce

10:1 From there he went[p] to places in Judaea and beyond the Jordan. Again, crowds went[p] with him; and he was teaching them like usual.

2Pharisees came and asked if a man could legally divorce his wife—testing him.

3He answered, *"What did Moses command you?"*

4*"Moses allowed a husband* ***to divorce his wife in writing"*** **[Deut 24:1, 3].**

5Jesus said, *"He wrote that because of your hardheartedness.* **6***From the beginning of creation,* ***'he made them male plus female*** **[Gen 5:2].** **7*****So a man is to leave his parents and unite with his wife,*** **8*****and they are to become one physical unit'*** **[Gen 2:24]***; they're no longer two but one.* **9***What God has joined, people are not to separate."*

10In the house the disciples asked him about it again.

11*"Whoever divorces his wife and marries another woman commits adultery against her.* **12***If a woman divorces her husband and marries another man, she commits adultery."* **Mk 10:1-12**

Jesus and the Little Children

13People were bringing their kids so he could touch them, but the disciples fussed at them. **14**When Jesus saw it, he was indignant, *"Let them come to me. Don't get in their way. The kingdom of God is made up of people like them.* **15***Whoever doesn't welcome The kingdom of God like a little child, will certainly not get into it."* **16**He hugged them, blessed *them*, and laid hands on them. **Mk 10:13-16**

The Rich Young Ruler

17As he was going out to the road, a man ran and knelt to him, *"Good Rabbi, what do I need to do to inherit eternal life?"*

18Jesus said, *"Why are you calling me good? Only God is good.* **19***You know the commandments,* ***'do not murder, commit adultery, steal, lie, or swindle; respect your parents"*** **[Ex 20:12-16; Deut 5:16-20; 24:14].**

20*"I've kept all those since I was a boy."*

21Jesus looked at him and liked him, *"There is one thing you lack. Sell what you own, give it to the poor, and you'll have wealth in heaven; come with me."*

22He was shocked and went away discouraged because he owned a lot. **Mk 10:17-22**

The Peril of Wealth

23Jesus looked around and said[p] to his disciples, *"It's going to be so hard for wealthy people to get into The kingdom of God."*

24That surprised the disciples, but he said[p] it again; *"Children, it's so hard to get into The kingdom of God.* **25***It's easier for a camel to go through a needle's eye than for rich people to get into The kingdom of God."*

26They were surprised even more and said to one another, *"So who can be saved?"*

27Jesus looked at them and said[p], *"It's not possible with people, but with God everything's possible."*

28Peter spoke up, *"We've left everything to follow you."*

29Jesus said, *"Everybody that's left a house, brothers, sisters, mother, father, children, or fields for my sake and the gospel message* **30***will receive houses, brothers, sisters, mothers, children, and fields 100 times over in this age with persecution and eternal life in the age to come.* **31***Many first will be last and last, first."* **Mk 10:23-31**

Another Prediction of His Death

32On the way up to Jerusalem, Jesus was ahead of them. They were wondering what was going to happen, and the people behind were afraid. He called the Twelve again and explained to them what was about to happen to them: **33***"In Jerusalem I'll be betrayed to the chief priests and the scribes. They'll condemn me to death and turn me over to the Gentiles.* **34***They'll make fun of me, spit on me, flog me, and put me to death. Three days later I'll resurrect."*

Mk 10:32-34

James and John's Request for Rank

35James and John, Zebedee's sons, came[p], saying, *"Rabbi, we want you to do something."*

36*"What is it?"*

37*"Let us sit on your right and left hand in your glory."*

38Jesus told them, *"You don't know what you're asking. Can you drink the cup I drink and be baptized with the baptism I'm baptized with?"*

39*"Yes."*

Jesus called them over to him, *"You'll drink the cup I drink* all right *and be baptized with the baptism I'm baptized with.* **40***But I'm not the One that decides who sits on my right and left hand. They're the ones* it's *prepared for."*

41When the ten heard it, they got indignant about what James and John had done.

42Jesus said[p],

> *"You know that national rulers tend to lord it over their people; their great ones tyrannize them.* **43***It's not that way with you. Whoever wants to be great among you will serve you,* **44***whoever wants to be first among you will serve you all.* **45***Even I didn't come to be served, but to serve, and to give my life as a ransom for many."* **Mk 10:35-45**

Healing a Blind Man at Jericho

46They came[p] to Jericho. As he, his disciples, and a sizeable crowd were leaving the city, Bartimaeus (*"Son of Timaeus"*), a blind beggar, was sitting by the road. **47**When he heard it was Jesus the Nazarene, he started yelling, *"Jesus son of David, have mercy on me!"*

48People told him to quiet down, but he yelled louder, *"Son of David, have mercy on me."*

49Jesus stopped, *"Call him* over here*."*

They called[p] him, *"It's okay; get up; he's calling for you."*

50He threw his cloak aside, jumped up, and went to Jesus.

51Jesus answered him, *"What do you want me to do for you?"*

"Rabbi, I want to see again."

52*"Go on, your faith has made you able to see."* Instantly he could see again, and he went with Jesus on the road. **Mk 10:46-52**

The Triumphal Entry

11:1 When they got[p] close to Jerusalem—to Bethphage and Bethany, on The Mount of Olives, he sent[p] two disciples, **2***"Go in the village over there. Just inside, you'll find a donkey colt tied that nobody has ridden. Untie it and bring it here.* **3***If anybody asks why you're doing that, say, 'The Lord needs it,' and he'll send[p] it here right away."*

4They went and found the colt tied at the gate outside on the street and untied[p] it. **5**Some of the ones standing there said, *"What're you doing, untying the colt?"*

6The disciples said what Jesus told them to say, and they let them take it. **7**They brought[p] it to Jesus and put[p] their cloaks on it, and he sat on it. **8**People spread their cloaks on the road or *brought* leafy branches they'd cut out of the fields. **9**The ones in front and behind started shouting,

> ***"Hosanna!***
>
> ***Blessed be the one that's coming in the name of the LORD*** **[Ps 118:25-26]!**
>
> **10***Blessed is the coming kingdom of our ancestor David.*
>
> ***Hosanna*** *in the highest!"*

11He went into the Temple in Jerusalem and looked around at everything. It was evening already , and he went out to Bethany with the Twelve. **Mk 11:1-11**

Cursing the Fig Tree;
Second Cleansing of the Temple

12The next day, when they left Bethany, he was hungry. **13**From a distance he saw a fig tree leafed out and went to see if, by chance, he'd find anything on it. He didn't find anything but leaves—it wasn't time for figs yet. **14**He said to it, *"May nobody ever eat fruit from you* again*."* His disciples were listening.

15They went[p] into Jerusalem into the Temple, and he started putting the buyers and sellers out of the Temple and turned over the tables of the moneychangers and the chairs of the ones selling doves. **16**He wouldn't let anybody take anything through the Temple, **17***"Doesn't scripture say,*

> ***'Call my house a house of prayer for all the nations'****?* **[Is 56:7]**
> *You've made it* ***'a den of thieves'****!"* **[Jer 7:11]**

18The chief priests and scribes heard about it and kept looking for a way to destroy him because they were afraid of him, and the crowd was astonished at his teaching.

19In the evening, he *and his disciples* would leave the city. **Mk 11:12-19**

Discussing the Shriveled Fig Tree

20As they went by early *the next morning*, they saw the fig tree all shriveled up. **21**Peter remembered, *"Rabbi, look, the fig tree you cursed is all shriveled up!"*

22Jesus said[p], *"Trust God. **23**Whoever says to this mountain, 'Be picked up and thrown into the sea,' and doesn't doubt, it'll happen. **24**Whatever you pray for, believe you've as good as received[aorist], and you will. **25**When you stand praying, if you have anything against anybody, forgive them so your Father in heaven will forgive you."* [**26**][ms] **Mk 11:20-26**

Jesus' Authority Challenged

27They went[p] into Jerusalem again. While he was walking in the Temple, the chief priests, scribes, and elders came[p], **28***"What right do you have to do this? Who gave you that right?"*

29Jesus said, *"I'll ask you something. Answer me and I'll tell you what right I have to do this. **30**Was John's baptism from heaven or people? Answer me."*

31They consulted with one another, *"If we say, 'From heaven,' he'll say, 'Why didn't you believe him?' **32**But if we say, 'From people'"*—they were afraid of the crowd because they all certainly considered John a prophet. **33**They answered[p], *"We don't know."*

Jesus said[p], *"I won't tell you either what right I have to do this."* **Mk 11:27-33**

Story About a Vineyard

12:1 He started telling them stories.

> *"A man planted a vineyard, put a wall around it, dug a wine pit with a trough under it, rented it out to tenants, and left on a trip. **2***At* harvest *time he sent a servant to the tenants to get* his *part of the fruit from the vineyard. **3***They took*

him and beat him *up and sent* him *away empty-handed.* [4]*He sent another servant, and they beat him over the head and abused him.* [5]*He sent another, and they killed him.* He sent *many others. They beat up some and killed others.*

[6]*"He still had one, dear son. He sent him to them last, 'They'll respect my son.'* [7]*But those tenants said to one another, 'This is the heir. Come on, let's kill him, and the inheritance will belong to us.'* [8]*They took* him*, threw him out of the vineyard, and killed him.* [9]*What will the owner do? He'll come and destroy those tenants and give the vineyard to other people.* [10]*You've even read this scripture, haven't you:*

'A stone the masons set aside
has become a cornerstone.
[11]***That's the LORD's doing;***
it's amazing.'" **[Ps 118:22-23]**

[12]The *Pharisees* were looking for some way to arrest him, but they were afraid of the crowd. They knew he'd aimed the story at them, and they left. **Mk 12:1-12**

Question About Tribute to Caesar

[13]They sent[p] some Pharisees and Herodians to trap him in what he said. [14]They said[p], *"Rabbi, we know you tell the truth, you don't defer to anybody, you don't respect persons, you teach the way of God correctly. Is it lawful to pay tribute to Caesar? Should we or not?"*

[15]He saw through their hypocrisy, *"Why are you trying to put me on the spot? Bring me a denarius."*

[16]They brought him one, and he said, *"Whose image and inscription is this?"*
"Caesar's."

[17]*"So pay Caesar what you owe Caesar and* pay *God what you owe God."*
They were stunned. **Mk 12:13-17**

Question About Resurrection

[18]The Sadducees came[p]—who say there's no resurrection,

[19]*"Rabbi, Moses wrote to us that* ***if a man's brother dies*** *and* ***leaves*** *a wife and* ***no child, his brother is to marry the wife and raise up heirs for his brother*** **[Gen 38:8; Deut 25:5]**. [20]*There were seven brothers. The first married a wife and didn't leave any offspring when he died.* [21]*The second married her and died, with no offspring. The third did the same thing.* [22]*All seven died, not leaving any offspring. Last of all, the woman died too.* [23]*Whose wife will she be in the resurrection? The seven had her as a wife."*

[24]Jesus said,

"Aren't you mistaken because you don't know the scriptures or God's power? [25]*When people resurrect, they don't marry. They're like angels in heaven.*

[26]*"As to the resurrection of the dead, you've read, haven't you, in the book of Moses in the bush passage how God spoke to him:* ***'I'm the God of Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob'****?* **[Ex 3:6, 15-16]** [27]*He's not a God of the dead but of the living. You're greatly mistaken."* **Mk 12:18-27**

Question About the Most Important Commandment

28When one of the scribes heard them arguing and saw that Jesus had answered them well, he came and asked, *"What is the most important commandment?"*

29Jesus answered, *"The most important is,* ***'Listen, Israel, the LORD*** is ***our God; the LORD is*** the ***one*** God***.*** **30*Love the LORD your[sg] God with all your heart, your soul,*** *your mind,* ***and your strength'*** **[Deut 6:4-5].** **31***The second is,* ***'Love your neighbor as yourself'*** **[Lev 19:18].** *There's no commandment more important than those."*

32The scribe said, *"Well put, Rabbi; you're right because* ***he is the one*** *God* **[Deut 6:4]*;*** ***there is no other*** *God* ***besides him*** **[Deut 4:35; Is 45:21].** **33*Loving him with all*** *your* ***heart, mind*** **[Deut 6:5; Josh 22:5]***, and strength, and* ***loving*** your ***neighbor as yourself*** **[Lev 19:18]** *is more* important *than all burnt offerings and sacrifices."*

34Jesus saw he'd made a sensible comment, *"You're not far from the kingdom of God."*

Nobody dared to ask him any more questions. **Mk 12:28-34**

Question About the Son of David

35After he answered *those questions*, as he was teaching in the Temple, he said, *"How can the scribes say that the Messiah is David's son?* **36***David said by the Holy Spirit,*

'The LORD said to my Lord,
"Sit at my right hand
till I put your enemies under your feet"' **[Ps 110:1].**

37*David himself called him 'Lord'; how can he be his son?"* The huge crowd loved it.

Denunciation of the Pharisees

38In his teaching, he was saying, *"Watch out for the Pharisees. They like to walk around in long robes, receive greetings in marketplaces,* **39***occupy prominent seats in synagogues and places of honor at banquets.* **40***They confiscate widows' houses and offer long prayers for show. They'll receive more severe condemnation."* **Mk 12:35-40**

The Widow's Mite

41He sat down across from the treasury box, watching *people from* the crowd put copper coins in the treasury box. Wealthy people were putting in big amounts. **42**A poor widow came and put in two leptons, which equal a quadrans. **43**He called his disciples over, *"That poor widow put in more than all the others.* **44***They donated out of their abundance, but she donated out of her poverty—everything she had to live on."* **Mk 12:41-44**

The Olivet Discourse

13:1 As he was leaving the Temple, one disciple said[p], *"Rabbi, look at what wonderful stones and magnificent buildings!"*

2Jesus said, *"You see these large buildings? Not one stone here will be left on top of another."*

3When he was sitting on The Mount of Olives across from the Temple, Peter, James, John, and Andrew asked him privately, **4***"Tell us when that will happen and what will indicate that it's about to happen."*

5Jesus told them,

"Make sure nobody deceives you. [6]Many will come, claiming to be the Messiah, and deceive lots of people. [7]When you hear about wars and reports about wars, don't panic. They need to happen, but that's not the end yet. [8]Nation will attack nation; kingdom will attack kingdom. There'll be earthquakes and famines in many places. They're the beginning of labor pains. **Mk 13:1-8**

[9]*"Watch out. They'll take you to court and flog you in the synagogues. You'll stand in front of governors and kings to speak* for me. [10]*The good news needs to reach all the countries first.* [11]*When they arrest you and put you on trial, don't worry about what you're going to say. Say what comes to you at that time; you won't be the ones speaking; it'll be the Holy Spirit.* [12]*Brother will betray brother to death, and father will betray child. Children will rise up against parents and have them put to death.* [13]*People will hate you because of me. The one that endures to the end will be saved.*

[14]*"When you see 'the abomination of desolation'* **[Dan 9:24; 11:11; 12:11]** *positioned where it shouldn't be* (reader, understand), *flee from Judaea to the hill country.* [15]*Don't come down from the housetop to get anything out of the house.* [16]*Don't go back go back from the field to get your coat.* [17]*How unfortunate for women that are pregnant or nursing babies then.* [18]*Pray that it won't happen during the winter.* [19]*It will be the worst time since the beginning of God's creation—or ever will be.* [20]*If the LORD hadn't cut the time short, nobody would survive. But, because of the Chosen, he has cut it short.* **Mk 13:9-20**

[21]*"If anybody says then, 'Here's the Messiah,' or 'There's* the Messiah*,' don't believe it.* [22]*False Messiahs and false prophets will arise and give signs and wonders to deceive, if they can, even the Chosen.* [23]*But you be careful. I've told you all this ahead of time.*

[24]*"After that distress,*
the sun will darken,
and the moon will dim;
[25]*stars will fall,*
and the powers in the heavens will be shaken.
[26]*At tht time people will see* ***the Son of Man coming on the clouds*** **[Dan 7:13-14]** *with great power and glory.* [27]*He'll send out his angels to gather the Chosen from every direction, from the end of earth to the end of sky.*

[28]*"Take a lesson from a fig tree. When its branches start to but and sprout leaves, you know summer's coming.* [29]*The same way, when you see that happening, know it's time.* [30]*It'll take place in <u>this</u> generation.* [31]*Earth and sky will pass away, but what I say won't pass away.* **Mk 13:21-31**

[32]*"But nobody knows about <u>that</u> day or hour—not the angels in heaven, not the Son of Man, only the Father.* [33]*Be careful, stay alert; you don't know when it will happen[p].* [34]*A man leaving on a trip gives each servant the authority to do his job and tells the doorkeeper to stay alert.* [35]*Watch; you don't know when the master of the household will come back—in the evening, at midnight, at*

rooster crowing, or in the morning—[36]*so if he comes unexpectedly, he won't catch you sleeping.* [37]*What I'm saying I'm saying to all of you. Watch!"* **Mk 13:32-37**

Fifth Prediction of His Death

14[:1]The Passover and Festival of Unleavened Bread was two days away. The chief priests and scribes were trying to find a way to arrest Jesus by stealth and put him to death. [2]They said, *"Not during the festival; the people will riot."* **Mk 14:1-2**

The Anointing of Jesus by Mary

[3]When he was in Bethany in the house of Simon the leper, reclining *at table*, a woman came with an alabaster cruise of expensive pure nard ointment. She broke open the alabaster cruise and poured it on his head. [4]Some were expressing their indignation to one another, *"Why has she wasted that ointment?* [5]*She could've sold it for over 300 denarii and given it to the poor."* They started fussing at her.

[6]Jesus said, *"Leave her alone. Why are you bothering her? She's done me a good turn.* [7]*You always have poor people around; you can do something good for them any time. You won't always have*[p] *me.* [8]*She did what she could: she anointed my body ahead of time for burial.* [9]*Wherever you deliver the good news in the world, tell what she's done in memory of her."* **Mk 14:3-9**

Judas' Plot to Betray Jesus

[10]Judas Iscariot, one of the Twelve, went to the high priests to deliver Jesus to them. [11]When they heard his offer, they were elated and promised to give him silver; so he started looking for a chance to turn him over. **Mk 14:10-11**

Preparation for the Passover Meal

[12]On the first day of Unleavened Bread, when the Passover *lambs* were sacrificed, his disciples said[p], *"Where do you want us to get things ready for you to eat the Passover?"* [13]He sent[p] two disciples, *"On the way in the city, you'll meet a man carrying a clay pot of water. Follow him,* [14]*and where he goes in, say to the owner, 'The Rabbi says, "Where's the guest room so I can eat the Passover with my disciples?"'* [15]*He'll show you a big upstairs room, furnished and set up. Get things ready for us there."*

[16]The disciples went in the city and found it like Jesus had said and got things ready. **Mk 14:12-16**

The Passover Meal;
Judas Identified as Traitor

[17]He arrived[p] that evening with the Twelve. [18]As they were reclining *at table* eating, he said[p], *"One of you that's eating with me is going to betray me."*

[19]They became sad and said one by one, *"It's not me, is it?"*

[20]He said, *"It's one of the Twelve that's dipping with me in the bowl.* [21]*The Son of Man will go*[p] *like scripture says, but how tragic for the one that betrays him! It would've been better for him if he hadn't been born."* **Mk 14:17-21**

The Lord's Supper Instituted

22During the meal Jesus took a loaf, blessed it, broke it, and handed it to them: *"Take it; this is my body."* **23**He took a cup, gave thanks, handed it to them, and they all drank it. **24**He said, *"This is my blood of the covenant that's shed for many.* **25***This is the last time I drink the fruit of the vine till I do it in The kingdom of God."*

26They sang a hymn and went out to The Mount of Olives. **Mk 14:22-26**

The Disciples Warned

27Jesus told[p] them, "*You're all going to desert me because scripture says,*

'I'll strike down the shepherd,
***and* his *sheep will scatter'* [Zech 13:7].**

28*But after I resurrect, I'll go ahead of you to Galilee."*

29Peter said, *"Even if everybody else deserts you, I won't."*

30Jesus said[p], *"I tell you, before a rooster double-crows in the morning, you're going to deny me three times."*

31But he kept insisting, *"Even if I have to die with you, I won't deny you."*

That's what they all said. **Mk 14:27-31**

The Agony in the Garden

32They came[p] to a place named Gethsemane, and he told[p] his disciples, *"Sit here while I pray."* **33**He took[p] Peter, James, and John with him, and began to feel stress and dread. **34***"I'm really stressed. Stay here and keep watch."* **35**He went on a little way and fell on the ground, and prayed that, if possible, the time would pass him by. **36***"Abba (Father), you can do anything. Take this cup away from me. But not what I want, but what you want."* **37**He came[p] and found[p] them sleeping and said[p] to Simon, *"You're[sg] sleeping? Couldn't you[sg] watch for one hour?* **38***Watch[pl] and pray so you[pl] won't be tempted. The spirit's willing but the flesh is weak."* **39**He went again and prayed the same thing. **40**When he came back, he found them sleeping; they couldn't keep their eyes open. They didn't know what to say. **41**He came[p] the third time, *"You're still sleeping and resting? That's enough; it's time. The Son of Man is being betrayed to sinners.* **42***Get up; let's go! The one that's betraying me is coming."* **Mk 14:32-42**

The Arrest of Jesus

43While he was still talking, Judas came[p] with a crowd from the chief priests, scribes, and elders, carrying[pl] swords and clubs. **44**The traitor had given them a signal, *"The one I kiss is him. Arrest him and take him away under guard."* **45**He came right up to Jesus and said[p], *"Rabbi,"* and kissed him. **46**They grabbed Jesus and arrested him. **47**One of those standing by drew his sword and struck the high priest's servant and cut off his ear. **48**Jesus responded to them, *"You've come out* here *with swords and clubs to arrest me like an insurgent?* **49***I was with you every day in the Temple teaching, and you didn't arrest me. But* this is happening *to fulfill the scriptures."* **50***The disciples* ran away. **51**A young man was following him wearing nothing but a linen sheet around his naked body. They grabbed at[p] him, **52**but he left the sheet behind and fled naked.

53They took Jesus to the high priest. The chief priests, elders, and scribes convened[p]. **54**Peter followed him at a distance into the high priest's courtyard and sat down with the officers to warm himself by the fire. **Mk 14:43-54**

The Trial Before Caiaphas

55The chief priest and the full Sanhedrin were looking for testimony against Jesus so they could put him to death, but they couldn't find any. **56**A number of people gave false testimony against him, but their testimonies didn't agree with each other. **57**Some got up and gave false testimony, **58***"We heard him say he'd tear down this sanctuary made with hands and build another one in three days without hands."* **59**Their testimonies didn't agree even on that point.

60The high priest stood up and asked Jesus, *"You are not answering, are you, anything these men are testifying against you?"*

61He didn't answer.

The high priest asked him again, "*Are you the Messiah, the Son of the Blessed?"*

62*"I am;*

*'**You'll see the Son of Man***
***sitting on the right hand of Power** and* **[Ps 110:1]**
***coming with the clouds**'"* **[Dan 7:13].**

63The high priest tore his clothes *in horror*, *"Why do we still need witnesses?* **64***You heard the blasphemy! What's your verdict?"*

They ruled for the death penalty.

65Some started spitting on him, blindfolding and slapping him, *"'Prophesy'* who did that*!"* The officers took him away, slapping him. **Mk 14:55-65**

Peter's Denials

66Peter was down below in the courtyard. A servant girl of the high priest came. **67**When she saw Peter warming himself, she looked at him closely, *"You were with the Nazarene, Jesus."*

68But he denied it, *"I don't know what you're talking about,"* and he went out to the entryway.

69The servant girl saw him again and started telling the ones standing around, *"This <u>is</u> one of them."*

70He denied it again.

A little later the ones standing around said <u>again</u>, *"You really <u>are</u> one of them; and you're a Galilean."*

71He started taking oaths and swearing, *"I don't know this man you're talking about."* **72**Immediately a rooster double-crowed, and Peter remembered: *"Before a rooster double-crows, you'll deny me three times."* He broke down sobbing. **Mk 14:66-72**

The Two Trials Before Pilate

15:1 At daylight, the chief priests held session with the elders, scribes, and the full Sanhedrin. They bound Jesus and led him away to Pilate. **2**Pilate asked him, *"Are you the 'King of the Jews'?"*

"Yes."

3The chief priests started accusing him of all kinds of things.

4Pilate asked him again, *"You're not saying anything? Look at all the things they're accusing you of."* **5**Jesus still didn't answer. Pilate was surprised.

6At each festival, Pilate would release a prisoner that they asked for. **7**A prisoner called Barabbas was incarcerated with insurgents that[pl] had committed murder in the uprising. **8**The crowd came forward and started asking *Pilate* to do as he customarily did for them.

9He answered, *"You want me to release 'the King of the Jews'?"* (**10**He knew the high priests had delivered him over because they were jealous of him.)

11But the high priests stirred up the crowd to ask for Barabbas instead.

12Pilate answered again, *"What do you want me to do then with the one you call 'the King of the Jews'?"*

13*"Crucify him!"*

14*"What's he done?"*

They shouted louder, *"Crucify him!"*

15Pilate wanted to satisfy the crowd, so he released Barabbas and delivered Jesus to be flogged and crucified. **Mk 15:1-15**

Torture by the Roman Soldiers

16The soldiers took him into the court—The Praetorium—and got[p] the whole cohort together. **17**They dressed[p] him in a purple *robe* and twisted together a crown made out of thorns and put[p] it on him. **18**They began to acclaim him, "*Hail, King of the Jews!"* **19**and were beating him on the head with a reed, spitting on him, and kneeling and bowing to him. **20**When they were done making fun of him, they took off the purple *robe* and dressed him in his own clothes, and took[p] him away to crucify him. **Mk 15:16-20**

The Way to Golgotha

21They conscripted[p] Simon, a Cyrenian coming in from the countryside—father of Alexander and Rufus—to carry his cross. **22**They took[p] him to Golgotha ("The Skull"), **23**and offered him wine mixed with myrrh, but he didn't take it. **24**They crucified[p] him and divided[p] up his clothes by casting lots for what each *soldier* would take. **Mk 15:21-24**

The Death of Messiah

25It was 9 o'clock when they crucified him. **26***Pilate* wrote his accusation above him, *"The King of the Jews."* **27**They also crucified[p] two insurgents with him, one on each side. [**28**][ms]

29The people going past were throwing insults at him and shaking their heads*, "Ha! You that tear down the sanctuary and rebuild it in three days,* **30***save yourself; come down from the cross!"*

31The chief priests along with scribes were making fun of him too, *"He saved other people; he can't save himself!* **32***Messiah, King of Israel, come down now from the cross so we can see and believe!"* Even the ones crucified with him were insulting him.

33At noon it got dark over the whole country till 3. **34**At 3 o'clock Jesus shouted, **"*Eloi, Eloi, lama sabachthani* (My God, my God, why have you deserted me) [Ps 22:1]?" 35**Some people standing nearby heard *it*, *"He's calling for Elijah."*

36One man ran and soaked a sponge with sour wine, put it on a reed, and gave him a drink, *"Let's see if Elijah will come[p] and take him down."*

37Jesus let out a loud cry and quit breathing. **Mk 15:25-37**

Miracles Accompanying Messiah's Death

38The curtain in the sanctuary tore in two, top to bottom. **39**When the centurion standing in front of him saw the way he quit breathing, he said, *"He really was God's Son."*

40*Some* women were also watching from a distance, including Mary the Magdalene; Mary, the mother of James the Less and Joses; and Salome. **41**When he was in Galilee, they traveled with him and helped him. *There were* several other women that came up with him to Jerusalem.

Mk 15:38-41

The Burial of Jesus
and Watch at the Tomb

42When evening came, since it was Preparation, the day before Sabbath, **43**Joseph of Arimathea—a prominent member *of the Sanhedrin*, who was waiting for the kingdom of God—gathered the courage to go in and ask Pilate for Jesus' body. **44**Pilate was surprised that he'd already died. He called the centurion to ask him if Jesus was dead already. **45**When he understood from him that Jesus was dead, he let Joseph have the body. **46**Joseph had bought a linen sheet; he took Jesus down and wrapped him in it. He put him in a rock-hewn tomb and rolled a stone over the entrance. **47**Mary the Magdalene and Mary, the *mother* of Joseph, were watching where they laid him. **Mk 15:42-47**

The Resurrection of Messiah

16:1 When Sabbath had passed, Mary the Magdalene; Mary, the *mother* of James; and Salome had bought aromatic spices to put on his body. **2**Very early on the first *day* of the week, they came[p] to the tomb as the sun was just starting to come up. **3**They were saying to one another, *"Who's going to roll the stone away for us from the entrance to the tomb?"* **4**When they looked up, they saw[p] that the really big stone had been rolled away. **5**They went into the tomb and saw a young man sitting on the right wearing a white robe, and they were startled. **6**He said[p], *"Don't be startled. You're looking for Jesus the Nazarene that was crucified. He's not here; he resurrected. See where they laid him. **7**Go tell his disciples--particularly Peter, 'He's going on ahead of you[pl] to Galilee. You'll see him there like he said.'"* **8**They went out and ran from the tomb because trembling and excitement gripped them. They didn't talk to anybody because they were afraid. **Mk 16:1-8**

Appearance to Mary the Magdalene

[[**9**After he'd resurrected early on the first *day* of the week, he appeared first to Mary the Magdalene, that he'd cast seven demons out of. **10**She reported it to the ones that had been with him, who were mourning and crying. **11**When they heard she'd seen him alive, they didn't believe it. **[Mk 16:9-11]**

Appearance to Two Disciples
and to the Ten

12After that, he appeared to two of them in a different form as they were walking[p] into *the* countryside. **13**They went back *to Jerusalem* to report it to the rest, *but* they didn't believe them either.
[**Mk 16:12-13]**

Appearance in Jerusalem

14Later, he appeared to the eleven themselves as they were reclining *at table* and chided them for their resistance to believing the ones that had seen him resurrected.

15He told them,

> *"Go all over the world and tell everybody the good news.* **16***Whoever believes and is baptized will be saved; whoever disbelieves will be condemned.* **17***These signs will follow the ones that believe:*
>
> *they'll cast out demons in my name;*
> *they'll speak in new languages;*
> **18***they'll pick up snakes, and*
> *if they drink any deadly poison, it won't hurt them;*
> *they'll lay hands on sick people, and they'll recover."* **[Mk 16:14-18]**

The Ascension

19After the Lord Jesus had spoken to them, he was taken up into heaven and sat down on God's right hand. **20***The disciples* went out and delivered the good news everywhere, and the Lord worked with them by confirming the message with the signs that followed.]] [**Mk 16:19-20]**